CASE STUDY



**Figure 4.10** The Canyon of Gandikota, the Pennar River in Andhra Pradesh

**Gandikota**, Kadapa district of Andhra Pradesh is known for its spectacular gorge formed by river Pennar that cuts through the Erramala hills. This handsome piece of Nature's architecture is known as the **Hidden Grand Canyon of India**. Magnificent Gandikota fort is located majestically on top of this gorge. Belum Cave found here is the second largest cave system in India. In fact, geologists have also found **surplus deposits of Quartz** in the stalactite and stalagmite formations of the cave. Adjacent to Gandikota fort, lies a magnificent lake that is believed to have been established by emperor Sri Krishnadevaraya using water from the Pennar river.

### Grooves

Long and narrow depression at the base of a waterfall made by river runoff is called a groove. The grooves are created by water eroding soil from a hill or mountain in a short period of time.

The swirling movement of the water falling into the plunge pool is called **eddying**.

### Interlocking spurs

An **interlocking spur**, also known as an **overlapping spur**, is a projecting ridge that extends alternately from the opposite sides of a V-shaped valley. A river with a winding course flows down the interlocking spur.

**Web link:**

More at https://www.livehistoryindia.com/geological-wonders/2017/05/24/gandikota-the-grand-canyon-of-india-2)



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